

Broken Needle Policy

M J Hunt & Son — Upper Assendon Farm, Stonor, Henley-on-Thames, Oxfordshire RG9 6HE

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Purpose

This policy sets out what to do if a needle breaks during the administration of a veterinary medicine, to protect animal welfare and food safety.

Procedure

- Stop the procedure immediately. Do not attempt to remove a broken needle fragment yourself unless part of it is still accessible and removal is straightforward and safe.
- If any part of the needle cannot be safely removed, contact the nominated vet (Larkmead Vet Group, 01491 651479) for advice.
- Permanently and clearly identify the affected animal (e.g. a dedicated ear tag colour, paint mark, or a note against its individual ID in the herd register) so it remains identifiable for the rest of its life.
- Record the incident in the medicine/incident records: date, animal ID, location of the fragment (if known), action taken, and who was informed.
- If the animal is later sent for slaughter, the abattoir and haulier must be informed in writing before dispatch, and the animal must remain identifiable up to the point of slaughter.
- The animal must not be sold or moved to another keeper without this information being passed on.

Record

Broken needle incidents are logged in the Farm Hub's Medicine section, cross-referenced to the animal's individual record.